



***E2* ACADEMIC POST**

Karen Yambay de Armijos



What is an **ACADEMIC POST ?**

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**An Academic Post refers to a short-written entry (a post)
for an academic-style forum, blog, or discussion board**

**Academic post = a practice writing task where you write a
formal contribution to an academic discussion platform
(like a class forum or student blog)**

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ACADEMIC POST

Your professor is teaching a class on education. Write a post responding to the professor's question.

- **In your response, you should do the following.**
- Express and support your opinion.
- Make a contribution to the discussion in your own words.
- An effective response will contain at least 100 words and a maximum of 120 words.

Sample Question

- **Professor:** In next week's class we'll talk about different approaches to education. You know, not everyone agrees about the best way for young people to gain knowledge and learn new skills. Let's prepare by discussing whether it's better for students to take classes with a lot of discussions or classes mainly focused on lectures. **What do you think?**
- **Rachel:** I prefer classes that have a lot of discussions. I just learn better when I'm actively engaged with academic material and can exchange ideas with my classmates. When I have the opportunity to get immediate feedback, I can understand things more deeply. I also benefit from hearing about different perspectives and new ways of thinking about challenging topics. Additionally, discussions help me retain the information better since they're more interactive and memorable.
- **Mike:** I see your point, Rachel, but I prefer lectures. I like being able to listen to an expert explain a topic and really get into it. With lectures, there's usually a clear structure and a set agenda, which can help me stay focused and organized. I also appreciate being able to take notes and study at my own pace. I can't do those things if I have to engage in a discussion. Not only that, but discussions can sometimes get off track or become too argumentative, which can take away from the learning experience.

Sample Answer

- ***In my opinion, interactive classes are much better than ones where we just sit and passively listen to a professor.*** I strongly agree with Rachel's perspective, and I would add that we need to prepare for discussions in advance, which also improves our retention of specific details and concepts. When we have a deeper understanding of academic topics, we get higher grades on tests and assignments. While Mike is right about the fact that it is hard to stay focused while a conversation is going on, it is extremely easy to record our classes. If we need to refer back to things that were mentioned in a class, we can just listen to a recording of it. **Overall, I'd say that** spirited discussions create a stimulating academic environment that everyone can benefit from.

STRUCTURE - ACADEMIC POST

Opinion: *In my opinion, interactive classes are much better than ones where we just sit and passively listen to a professor .*

Reason 1 + Support: I would add that we need to prepare for discussions in advance, which also improves our retention of specific details and concepts.

Reason 2 + Acknowledgement of Opposing Viewpoint:
While Mike is right about the fact that it is hard to stay focused while a conversation is going on, it is extremely easy to record our classes.

Response to a Classmate (Rachel) + Additional Concern:
I strongly agree with Rachel's perspective. If we need to refer back to things that were mentioned in a class, we can just listen to a recording of it.

Conclusion: Overall, I'd say that spirited discussions create a stimulating academic environment that everyone can benefit from.

ACADEMIC POST – Useful phrases

Opinion:

- *In my view, ...*
- *From my perspective, ...*
- *I strongly believe that ...*
- *It seems to me that ...*
- *There are different opinions on this issue, but I would argue that ...*
- *Although both points are valid, I consider that ...*

Reason 1 + Support:

- *One key reason for this is that ...*
- *To illustrate this, ...*
- *For example, ...*
- *This demonstrates that ...*
- *Another important factor is ...*
- *What makes this argument stronger is ...*

ACADEMIC POST – Useful phrases

Reason 2 + Acknowledgement of Opposing Viewpoint:

- *It is true that ...*
- *Supporters of the opposite opinion argue that ...*
- *One cannot deny that ...*
- *There is some truth in the idea that ...*
- *While this may be the case, ...*
- *Nevertheless, ...*
- *However, I would argue that ...*
- *Despite this,*

Conclusion:

- *In conclusion, ...*
- *To sum up, ...*
- *Overall, it seems clear that ...*
- *Therefore, I am convinced that ...*
- *Taking everything into account, ...*
- *Ultimately, ... outweighs ...*



Practice

- **Professor:** What helps students succeed at university?
- **Lizzy:** Having supportive teachers is the most important factor.
- **Paul:** Good study habits matter more than anything else.

Write an academic post (100-120 words) :

- State which opinion you agree with more.
- Give reasons to support your view.
- Refer to both opinions given.



STRUCTURE - ACADEMIC POST

Opinion:

Reason 1 + Support:

Reason 2 + Acknowledgement of Opposing Viewpoint:

Response to a Classmate + Additional Concern:

Conclusion:

